

RDTII Data Collection Hands-on Practice Assignment

Practice exercise for understanding data collection in real research settings and improving regulatory analysis workflow.

Assignment submission	Indicators	Deadline
Completed Excel dataset < [5th June] RDTII 2.1 data collection practice assignment > Via email attachment to escap-digitaltrade-hackathon@un.org	Required - Indicator 6.1 Singapore - Indicator 7.3 Malaysia Optional - Indicator 5.3 optional	Thursday, 11 June

Please Read First

This exercise is intended to help participants understand how RDTII researchers conduct fully manual data collection. To ensure the exercise serves its intended purpose, please **do not use AI tools**. Submissions that contain **clear signs of AI-generated** content will **not receive feedback**.

Objective

This assignment is intended to help participants better understand how **RDTII data collection works in real research settings**, and to support the development of more effective tools for regulatory analysis. This exercise is **not part of the mandatory submission agenda**, and submission **will not affect the final overall score or ranking of any team**.

Recommended Research Approach

For each case, follow the general workflow:

- Identify the correct indicator and its scope
- Identify the correct source (primary, official, enforced)
- Conduct structured extraction and interpretation
- Classify the measure according to the indicator logic
- Record the result in the database fields (see “**RDTII data collection practice format requirements**” for formality requirements)

Indicator 6.1 — Singapore

This case is designed to help you understand the boundary between Indicator 6.1 and Indicator 6.4.

- Define the indicator correctly:** Indicator 6.1 captures a ban on cross-border data transfer and/or a local processing requirement. It does not cover every rule that merely imposes conditions on data transfer.
- Identify the relevant source families:** Do not look only at the general data protection law. You should also consider whether relevant sectoral laws or regulations exist.

- **Extract the operative legal text and explain it:** If the law allows transfer subject to conditions such as comparable protection, consent, contractual safeguards, or approval, the provision is more likely to fall under Indicator 6.4 rather than Indicator 6.1.
- **Translate your finding into the database fields:** Record the legal source, scope, relevant provision, explanation, timeframe, and references.
- **Key lesson:** Do not miscode a transfer-limitation obligation as a ban, clearly distinguish the indicator scope.

Indicator 7.3 — Malaysia

This case is designed to help you understand the distinction between a minimum retention requirement and a retention-limitation principle.

- **Define the indicator correctly:** Indicator 7.3 captures rules that require data to be retained for at least a specified minimum period.
- **Start with the general law, but do not stop there:** You should first review the general privacy or data protection framework, but also check whether there are relevant sector-specific laws or regulations.
- **Extract the operative text and interpret it carefully:** A rule stating that data must not be kept longer than necessary is not the same as a rule requiring data to be retained for a minimum period.
- **Translate your finding into the database fields:** Record the legal source, scope, relevant provision, explanation, timeframe, and references.

***Key takeaway:** A general privacy law may only be the starting point. The decisive retention rule may appear in a sectoral or technical instrument. One indicator may include multiple horizontal and sectoral legal sources.*

Indicator 5.3 — India (Optional)

This optional case is designed to help you understand how to work with a practice-oriented indicator, where both primary legal sources and factual materials may matter.

***Key lesson:** The question is not simply whether there is a law, but what the official evidence of government ownership in telecom companies is.*

- **Define the indicator correctly:** Indicator 5.3 asks whether the Government owns shares in telecom companies, and whether the ownership threshold is met.
- **Identify the evidence base:** Primary sources may include official Government or regulator materials. Factual or supporting materials may include annual reports, official company websites, and official ownership records.
- **Extract and explain the relevant information:** Clearly identify the company name, ownership percentage, source of that information, and the relevant timeframe.
- **Translate your finding into the database fields:** Record the evidence and explain why it is relevant to the indicator.

***Key takeaway:** Some indicators cannot be completed by relying on a single legal provision alone. They require a combination of legal analysis and factual verification.*

****Inserting format for improved readability: see “RDTII data collection practice format requirements” for formality requirements.***